



PANKAJ SONI (PGDM, Indian Institute of Management, Lucknow [2015])

PRINCE2 Foundation and Practitioner certified/ Certified Scrum Master

Certificate of Completion in Accenture's "Virtual Consulting Experience Program" - Accenture Discovery Program

SKILLS SUMMARY

- A high performing, driven, resourceful Technical Program Manager and a Delivery Specialist with 10+ years of experience in providing guidance to B2B customers on IT strategy, technology and functionality needed within the context of their IT and business environments and goals, possessing a deep understanding of **Agile framework and project methodology**
- Exceptional ability to understand and simplify complex issues while building trust with internal and external customers. Effectively manage global resources to ensure maximum bottom line performance and deliver rapid resolution to production and process issues and time-to-market goals
- **Program Management, SAP ERP Implementations, IT Integration – SAP, IT Strategy Consulting, Process Improvement, Digital Transformation, Customer Experience, Stakeholder Management, Team Leadership, Cost/Financial/ROI Optimization, Automation, Change Management**
- Rich experience working with top international clients providing technology-enablement services across a broad spectrum of consumer facing industries in Telecommunications/VAS, Insurance, Consumer Packaged Goods, Banking and Financial Services, Retail, Healthcare, Automotive, Pharmaceutical, Infrastructure and Energy, Oil and Gas, Life Sciences, Logistics, Transportation and Chemicals sectors
- International exposure of working with cross-cultural teams across accounts, geographies, and markets

EDUCATION

Year	Degree	Institute/School
2015	PGDM	Indian Institute of Management, Lucknow
2009	B.E. (Electrical Engineering)	Swami Keshvanand Institute of Technology, Jaipur
2004	CLASS XII	RBSE (Sardar Doon School, Jodhpur)
2002	CLASS X	RBSE (Sardar Doon School, Jodhpur)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Total: (10.5+ Years); Post MBA (7.25+ Years)

Senior Project Manager – Professional Services Delivery

Innovapptive Inc.

Sep '21 – Oct '22 (13 Months)

- Lead the entire life-cycle delivery of multiple Implementation, Rollout, Upgrade and POC programs catering to Innovapptive's product suite - Android and iOS mobility solutions (Connected Workforce Platform) for maintenance and repair operations related to Enterprise Asset Management (EAM), Warehouse Management (WM) and Materials Management (MM) with direct responsibility for managing project teams, schedules, scope, quality, and budget
- Engage at CxO level, representing Project Steering Committee Executive Boards with success
- Capitalize on negotiation, conflict management, and leadership skills and maintain trusted advisor relationships with client project stakeholders, delivering digital transformation through focused customer journey experience management
- Manage, maintain, and support the 15–20-member delivery execution teams with consistent and effective use of processes and tools within portfolios, programs/projects, and build strong partnership across product and engineering stakeholders; lead a team of 3 Project Managers (direct reports) to provide them with the functional leadership support
- Strategic planning with Customer Executives and Sales to drive revenue expansion initiatives within the existing customer base through up sell and cross sell
- Identifying and resolving risks and issues as well as mitigation plans to address maintaining the project plan, RAID logs, resource plans, timesheets, and all required project details in Innovapptive's project management system
- Coordinate with the customer(s) and functional/technical project team members for end-to-end project delivery, tracking, and communications; efficiently manage stakeholders' expectations and customer communication
- Document all project deliverables in a timely manner and prepare, manage, and distribute weekly status reports to customer and Innovapptive leadership team
- Address customer and project escalations related to delivery quality, timeline or budget slips, scope misalignment and internal staffing decisions
- Financial management and responsibility for overall Services revenue and margin attainment related to the project portfolio
- Assist PMO in drafting SOWs and RFPs, and in identifying, documenting, and implementing process and method improvements

Senior Manager-Project Management

Max Life Insurance

Sep '19 – July '21 (23 Months)

- **Projects:** Single-handedly managed timely filings and launches of **10+ new products, 12+ minor modifications**
- Enabled regular communication with **IRDAI** to track the file's progress for queries and approvals within the TAT
- Ensured operational governance – liaised regularly with cross-functional teams to drive timely product launches
- Managed half-yearly, quarterly annexures and compliance submissions to IRDAI, ensuring their correctness and timeliness
- Ensured that the repository is updated with all relevant documents and that it is made more scientific and comprehensive

- Drove product sanity and recertification by adhering to product development process, identified issues & their rectification
- Streamlined “Product Development/Modification Process” for **faster error-free GTM** and for improving **NPS**
- Identified improvement areas through continuous process review and ensured that past learnings are baked in NPD

Senior Technical Program Manager (Global Delivery) Mahindra Comviva April '15 – Aug '19 (52 Months)

- **Program management:** Service delivery for clients across geographies, by assisting stakeholders in the definition of project scope/objectives & ensuring technical feasibility, thus resulting in **highly productive customer engagements**; Executed **on-time and on-budget** delivery of **40+** projects in the entire tenure; worth approx. **\$ 8 Mn**, with full P&L ownership
- **Infrastructure project management** by working closely with Vendor Managers for **cloud performance** and **SLA Management**; including infrastructure planning, identification of goals and tracking overall performance of these projects
- Developed comprehensive project plans involving design, development and testing of **enterprise systems** such as **Enterprise Cloud Solution, CRM and ERP**, facilitated sprint planning, retrospectives, and other scrum ceremonies
- Managed changes to the project scope, project schedule and project costs using appropriate verification techniques, met budgetary objectives and **adjusted project constraints based on financial analyses**
- **Products:** Planned delivery of multiple **Analytics & Fin-tech** products such as Mobile Money, Digital Wallets, Pre-Tups, Pre Paid Recharge platform, Enterprise Communication platform, SMS centers, End of Call Notifications,
- **Client Engagement:** Conducted program governance for tracking KPIs on a regular basis with various functional Directors and Heads and CEOs of Airtel, Vodafone, Etisalat, Ooredoo, Tigo, Idea, Orange MTN, spanning multiple geographies such as **Africa, India, South-East Asia, Latin America and MENA**
- Coordinated internal resources and third parties for the flawless execution of projects, ensured resource availability and allocation
- **People management:** **Liaised closely with different functions/business verticals** for delivering the projects in-line with the desired KPIs – Marketing, Legal, Sales and BD teams during pre-sales, bridging the gaps at any stage in pre-sales, post sales and post-handover, **built trusting relationships** with multiple **stakeholders** both **internal and external**
- Helped **define the SoW for Supply Chain/Vendor management activities**, by reviewing the contract terms for invoicing and payment related milestones, and by ensuring delivery of hardware and software licenses to the int'l customer location
- Developed **smart, compelling dashboards and reports** for tracking **KPIs**, identifying trends and for project governance with the customer leadership and internal Business Unit heads; created and maintained comprehensive project documentation
- **Generated** revenue worth **USD 90000** by identifying change requests for business users of client, across all projects
- **Risk Management:** Identified risks & prepared mitigation plans resulting in cost savings of **1 M USD** across clients
- Helped **improve CSAT** scores by **over 25%**, ensured **100% FTR**, thus generating repeat/referral services
- Received **Mahindra Credo Cap award** for **customer responsiveness** and **on budget delivery** categories in 2017
- One of the top **5%** employees to achieve **“Best Talent”** rating in the performance reviews held in 2016 and 2017

Key Programs' Highlights

- Led the delivery for data migration of current Prepaid/Postpaid/Hybrid Subscribers from Tigo CRM/Billing system to iPACS(Integrated Provisioning & Customer Care system), resulting in the merged entity having the largest customer base in Rwanda with 5.05 million subscribers; advised on **IT consolidation** across **applications, infrastructure and operating model**
- Spearheaded a program that enabled cashless mobile money payments in the country by setting up an ecosystem comprising NFC enabled POS devices & cards
- Instrumental in a program winning the "Global Telecom Business Innovation Award" at the "GTB Innovation & Technology Summit" in London in 2016
- Helped improve the corporate rating from **A to AA** vis-à-vis legal and regulatory requirements with the deployment on existing platform, of EIR - a strategic solution to prevent the use of stolen, cloned and reused devices and to minimize fraud
- Detection of fraud increased by **15%** and **ARPU** increased by **9%**, thus resulting in higher strategic value to the organization
- Allowed the platform to scale horizontally and vertically, bringing costs down by **16%** and decreasing time by **20%**
- Implemented **Business Transformation framework** in line with **Agile** methodology from project **Planning to Closure**

Senior System Engineer Infosys Limited Oct '09 - May '13 (43 Months)

- Led a cross-functional team & benchmarked **process KPIs** across 8 projects effecting **\$0.2 m cost savings**
- Successfully implemented a pilot release of a previously failed financial customization project for **AFS**
- Improved the page rendering performance of the entire web-based application for **RBS** by **40%**
- Helped senior executives transition the project from an **SDLC** domain to one driven by **agile** methodology
- Implemented **TCoE** in System Testing phase to perform a gap analysis on current testing practices in project
- Instrumental in raising the **CMMI** level of the Capital One project from **level 3 to level 5**, in a span of 9 months
- Rated **CRR 1+**, topmost rating given to only **top 5%** employees, in annual performance appraisal cycles of FY12 & FY13
- Recipient of **Infosys award for Excellence** for manifesting consistent stellar performance in consecutive appraisal reviews

LIVE PROJECTS AND BUSINESS SCHOOL COMPETITIONS

Pepsi (2014)

- **Conducted field study** and identified key potential issues leading to “Slice” share loss in Lucknow

ITC Interrobang (2014)

- Recommended **Marketing Positioning strategy** for Engage deodorant; secured the **2nd Runners up** position **Coca- Cola show case (2014)**
- Devised a **promotional campaign** for celebrating *100 years of Coke bottle*; stood as the Campus finalist **Marico Over the Wall (2013)**
- Studied consumer perception of Saffola Oats and suggested re-positioning; stood as the Campus finalist **Academic Projects**
- **BI & Data Mining (2014)**
- Learnt data mining techniques & their applications in Database marketing, CRM using **SAS Enterprise Miner**
- **Promotional Strategy (2014)**
- Designed a promotional strategy via ad animation route for a tourism place and for a competition handbook
- **Financial Statement Analysis (2014)**
- Carried out a financial-health analysis of ACC & Ambuja Cements vis-à-vis various financial statements

LEADERSHIP ROLES AND PEOPLE SKILLS

Core Member, Placement Operations, IIM Lucknow, 2014

- **Scheduled & planned** liaisons for the process with over **300 companies** during summers & finals

Member, Voice of Youth, Infosys, 2012 - 13

- Spearheaded a 4-day campaign at Pune DC to sensitize employees to reduce electricity consumption

Operations Head, Technical Fest (Techniscion), SKIT, 2005 - 07

- Managed logistics and operations for **25** inter-college events with a participation of **900+** students

Chief Coordinator, Pravaah (Cultural Fest), SKIT, 2006 - 08

- Led a team of 20 to organize the 4-day festival with a **footfall of 6000+** & a budget of **INR 13 lakhs**

EXTRA CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Sports & Indoor Games

- Selected (**1st out of 70**) to represent **IIML's Men's Carom team** at the inter-IIM meet, '**Sangharsh**', in 2014
- **2nd Runner-up**, Men's Singles Infosys **Badminton** Championship, among 20 participants, in 2011
- **Vocals: Winner, singing** competition, at the cultural event SPARK at Infosys, among **10** contestants in 2012
- **Social Service, IVS, Infosys**: Conceptualized **Mathematics Laboratory** in **8** govt. schools for **800+** students; invested **100 hours**